

Cristian Garza

OSCP CERTIFIED SECURITY PROFESSIONAL | EX-SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Houston, Texas

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Professional Summary

OSCP-certified security professional with 4+ years of software engineering experience across full-stack development, cloud infrastructure, and cybersecurity research tooling. Experienced on both sides: Active Directory exploitation, web application attacks, and post-exploitation through OSCP and HackTheBox, paired with detection engineering and SIEM monitoring in self-designed lab environments. 4+ years as a SWE means I read code and infrastructure the way an attacker will.

Experience

Texas Center for Cell Therapy and Research

San Antonio, Texas | Remote

CYBERSECURITY CONSULTANT

Sep. 2025 – Present

- Self-directed OSCP preparation alongside the role: 300+ hours of hands-on training in Active Directory exploitation, web application attacks, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation across Windows and Linux.
- Hardened endpoints by deploying BitLocker full-disk encryption and enforcing secure baseline configurations across all employee devices.
- Set up email domain, hosting, and basic authentication for the organization's small team.

CyManII (Cybersecurity Manufacturing Innovation Institute)

San Antonio, TX

SYSTEMS SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Dec. 2023 – Sep. 2025

- Developed software tools supporting cybersecurity research targeting industrial control systems (ICS) and manufacturing environments.
- Built containerized lab environments with Docker and Docker Swarm to simulate target infrastructure for security research workflows.
- Designed automated testing and validation pipelines in Python and JavaScript, cutting QA overhead and enabling reproducible research.
- Collaborated with DOE national labs, academic researchers, and industry partners on cybersecurity resilience projects for critical infrastructure.

Cariloop

Remote

FULL STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Jul. 2021 – Apr. 2023

- Developed and maintained full-stack web applications using TypeScript, Angular, and Loopback 4 in an agile environment.
- Designed and implemented RESTful backend services and third-party integrations while adhering to secure development practices.
- Deployed and managed production applications on AWS using Docker, Linux, and Nginx, ensuring high availability.
- Participated in code reviews and contributed to engineering standards to improve code quality and reduce security defects.

Security Labs & Projects

Detection Engineering & SIEM

cristiangarza.github.io/socdocs

SELF-BUILT SOC MONITORING LABS

2026

- **Purple Team SOC Detection Lab (Splunk):** Built an isolated multi-VM lab from scratch — pfSense-segmented network, Windows AD domain, and a Splunk SIEM ingesting Sysmon and Windows Event Logs via Universal Forwarders. Executed 13+ MITRE ATT&CK-mapped attacks (Kerberoasting, lateral movement, LSASS dumping, OWASP web attacks) and engineered a tuned Splunk detection for each, validated against live telemetry. Surfaced real detection gaps including default Sysmon configs silently omitting LSASS access events.
- **Cloud Detection Lab (Microsoft Sentinel):** Deployed Sentinel over a live Windows VM, streamed telemetry via Azure Monitor Agent, integrated MISP threat-intel feeds through a Python/Azure Functions pipeline, and authored custom KQL analytics rules. Validated end-to-end against self-generated attacks, including catching a WAF misconfiguration that silently allowed a SQL injection through.

Offensive Security & Exploitation

cristiangarza.github.io/writeups

HACKTHEBOX & OSCP LAB WRITE-UPS

2026

- **Arkham (HackTheBox):** Cracked a LUKS-encrypted SMB backup to recover a JSF HMAC secret, built a custom Python exploit for ysoserial deserialization RCE, and escalated by extracting credentials from an Outlook OST file and bypassing UAC via UNC self-reference.
- **BabyTwo (VulnLab):** Abused guest SMB for RID-brute enumeration, overwrote a misconfigured SYSVOL logon script for initial access, then used BloodHound to identify a Legacy → gpoadm → GPO GenericAll path and exploited it with pyGPOAbuse to reach Domain Admin.
- **Stratosphere (HackTheBox):** Identified Apache Struts via .action URL patterns, achieved RCE against a restricted no-egress service account, pivoted via plaintext MySQL credentials recovered through the RCE primitive, and escalated to root via Python library hijacking on a sudo-permitted script.

Security Engineering & Automation

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LLM-POWERED SECURITY TOOLING

2026

- **MCP-Based Vulnerability Triage Agent:** Built an MCP server exposing vulnerability scan data as callable tools and orchestrated an LLM tool-calling loop to automatically triage findings and generate prioritized, stakeholder-ready remediation reports.

Certifications

2026 **Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)**, Offensive Security
2023 **CompTIA Security+**, CompTIA

Education

The University of Texas at Austin
B.S. COMPUTER SCIENCE, CYBERSECURITY CONCENTRATION

Austin, TX
May 2021

Technical Skills

Detection & SIEM	Splunk (SPL), Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Sysmon, Log Analysis, Alert Triage
Offensive Security	Burp Suite, Metasploit, BloodHound, Impacket, Mimikatz, NetExec, Nmap
Frameworks	MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP Top 10, NIST SP 800-115
Programming & Scripting	Python, Powershell, JavaScript/TypeScript, Bash, C/C++, Java
Infrastructure & Cloud	AWS, Azure, Docker, Linux, Windows, Active Directory